

Stars Without Number Homebrew Ship Combat

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The Purpose

These are altered and expanded ship combat rules that eliminate the regular way players take actions in ship combat. Instead of department heads having to generate Command Points with their actions, each department automatically generates the required resources they need. This ensures that no player needs to feel incentivized to be a “power generator” whose only purpose is to feed the gunner with Command Points. The intention is that every player gets to participate to the combat in a fun way. Weapons have a maximum amount of times they can be fired to limit gunners from using all the Action Points on shooting.

How To Play

Each department starts with one Action Point at the beginning of their ship’s turn. More Actions can be gained in various ways, such as with the Above and Beyond General Action. Star Captain focus lets the captain choose any one department, granting that department one additional Action Point. The Volley Capacitor ship mod gives the gunnery department two additional Action Points that can be used to perform gunnery Actions, but not General Actions or the Blood Dimmed Tide Action.

Most Actions cost one Action Point to use. Some Actions are free and do not require Action Point to activate. They are marked with (free) tag next to their name.

NPC ships have Action Points depending on their crew skill and ship class. Non-military ships and fighters have 2 Action Points. Regular military ships have 3 Action Points, while those crewed by veterans have 4. In the case of a truly elite crew, the NPC ship has 5 Action Points. Such a crew can also accept two Crisis per combat unlike most NPC crews which will only accept one per combat. NPC ships don’t take Actions that add or give Action Points and in most cases they don’t take Captain actions.

Because the Command Points have been removed, the Haywire Systems Crisis incurs an Action penalty of 1 per Haywire Systems crisis. This makes it roughly analogous to the -2 Command Point penalty per Crisis in original rules.

Fighters

Command Points have been removed from fighter pilots just like they have been removed from other ships. Fighter pilots now have their own department and they gain 3 Action Points at the start of their turn. Some Actions in the new fighter department have (Fighter Pilot) tag next to their name to mark that despite their similarities, they do not function the same way as Actions with the same name in other departments.

If the fighter vessel has additional crew seats, each additional crew member gains 2 Action Points at the start of their turn. Depending on the vessel, the additional crewman usually fills the comms

department or operates the guns, being allowed to take the Fire One Weapon or Target a System Actions from fighter department. If they fill the comms department, they can take any of the comms Actions, including General Actions. The GM could also add vessels that have engineering department by using Virtual Intelligence robot to fill the position instead of a crewman in comms.

There are some changes to the Star Captain focus to make it also work as focus for fighter aces. Characters with Star Captain focus may now benefit from it while piloting a fighter despite it not being in a captain role. Level 1 Star Captain focus now allows choosing Pilot or Shoot skill in addition to Lead. The additional Action Point from Level 1 Star Captain focus is automatically given to the pilot, it cannot be given to the additional crew members. Level 2 works as before, but the bonus hit points and automatic resolution of a Crisis are also available to fighter pilots.

Pilots of fighters can accept a Crisis rather than have their craft suffer damage, just like other ships. Dealing with a crisis during combat while piloting a starfighter might well be impossible, so the difficulty of the skill check in the fighter pilots Deal With a Crisis Action is 12 instead of 10. In a fighter with more than one crew, the other crew members can take regular Deal With a Crisis Actions.

When the fighter is hit, the pilot can take damage instead of the vessel. This can be done after the damage has been rolled. However, since the damage levels for starship weapons aren't scaled to human hit points, if the pilot does elect to take the hit instead of the fighter, the weapon does additional 1D6 damage if it is a fighter weapon, or 2D6 if it's a frigate weapon or larger.

Pilots of fighters who have the Warrior class and have the Specialist (Pilot) or Star Captain focus may use the luck ability not just to hit with ship guns, but also to negate a hit against their fighter. It still cannot be used to negate hits made to frigates or larger vessels.

Terminology

Action: Each department in a ship has a list of Actions that are available for them to choose from.

Action Point (AP): Resource used to take Actions. At the beginning of each player ships turn each department in that ship gains one Action Point.

Free Action: An Action that does not require Action Point to be spent to be used.

General Action: Each department is able to choose from department specific Actions or from General Actions that are the same for all departments, except that fighter department has only fighter Actions.

Department: The ship departments are captain, bridge, comms, engineering, gunnery and fighter that is used only by the smallest class of spaceships. Players control one department each, or multiple if there aren't enough players.

Captain Actions

The captain is master of the ship and directs the other departments.

Support Department	Direct Intervention
Choose any other department. It gains one Action Point this round. You can do this once per round. If you use Support Department, you may not use Direct Intervention this round, and vice versa.	Roll Int/Lead or Cha/Lead against difficulty 9. On a success perform any two Actions from any other single department, using your Lead skill in place of skill normally associated with the action. The rolls suffer a -2 penalty. You can do this once per combat. The department head being replaced cannot use their Action Points to do anything other than Deal With a Crisis.
Keep It Together (free)	Into the Fire (free)
Negate a successful enemy hit and accept a Crisis instead. You must use this immediately after damage is rolled. You can perform this once per round.	Accept a Crew Lost Crisis and gain one additional Action Point this round that you can give to any department of your choice. You can perform this once per round.
Valiant Sacrifice (free)	You Magnificent Bastard!
Negate a successful enemy hit and accept a VIP Imperiled Crisis instead, with captain as the victim. Your ship also gains an additional Action Point on your next turn. You must use this Action immediately after damage is rolled. You can perform this once per round.	Having maneuvered the enemy into a perfect position, the captain springs the trap. Roll opposed Wis/Lead check plus Speed. If you win, targeted ship may not take any Actions on its next turn. You can perform this once per combat. This Action cannot be combined with any other Captain Action.

General Actions

Above and Beyond (Free)	Deal With a Crisis
Pick an attribute and a skill and explain how you're using them to help the ship. If the GM agrees, roll them against difficulty 9. On a success, you gain one Action Point that you may keep, or give to another department of your choice. On a failure, you lose one Action Point. You must not have taken Actions this turn to be able to use Above and Beyond. You can perform this once per round.	Explain what you are doing to solve a Crisis and roll the relevant skill check. The difficulty is usually 10, plus or minus 2 depending on the situation and how sound you plan is. On a success the Crisis is resolved. You may also use this Action to aid another PC in resolving a Crisis, or to take one scene's worth of other actions around the ship. Deal With a Crisis is exclusive; if you take this Action you can do nothing else in the round.

Bridge Actions

The bridge is where the ship's piloting and navigation is done.

Dogfight Maneuvering	Evasive Maneuvers
Roll an opposed Int/Pilot or Dex/Pilot check plus Speed against a target. On a success gain a hit bonus against that target equal to twice your Pilot skill level. The bonus lasts until the beginning of your next turn.	Roll an Int/Pilot or Dex/Pilot against difficulty 9. On a success add your Pilot skill to the ship's AC until its next turn. You may perform this multiple times per round.
Pursue Target	Escape Combat
Roll an opposed Int/Pilot or Dex/Pilot check plus Speed against the target. On a success you shed one point of Escape rating the target ship has on you.	Roll an opposed Int/Pilot or Dex/Pilot check plus Speed against the fastest opponent. On a success all enemy ships gain one point of Escape. If an enemy ship gets three points, your ship leaves combat. You may perform this twice per round.
Spitting Distance	Defensive Flying
The pilot brings the ship right up to close visual range with an enemy ship preventing them from bringing one of their guns to bear. Roll an opposed Int/Pilot or Dex/Pilot check plus Speed. The pilot can choose which enemy gun is neutralized, but all other attacks against the pilot's ship gain a +2 hit bonus, including the other guns of the targeted enemy.	Roll opposed Dex/Pilot or Int/Pilot plus Speed against the fastest enemy. On a success your ship gains temporary hit points equal to its Speed, plus twice your Pilot skill. These last until the beginning of your next turn. You can perform this once per round.
Between The Rain	
There must be two or more enemies firing on the ship. The pilot flies the ship between two chosen opponents on a carefully-calculated course vector. Roll Int/Pilot or Dex/Pilot against difficulty 9. On a success, until the beginning of your next turn, missed shots on you from either enemy must roll to hit the other at -4 penalty.	

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Comms Actions

The comms department handles communications, sensors, electronic warfare, and hacking.

Crash Systems	Sensor Ghost
Roll an opposed Int/Program check against a target. On a success, the target loses one Action Point on its next turn from. This Action can be performed multiple times in a round, targeting different ship each time.	Roll an Int/Program check against difficulty 9. On a success, gain your Program as an AC bonus until the beginning of your next turn.
Identify Weak Point	Defeat ECM
Roll an opposed Int/Program check against a target. On a success, attacks made by your ship against the target have a bonus to AP equal to twice your Program skill level. You can perform this multiple times in a round, targeting different ship each time.	Roll an opposed Int/Program check against a target. On a success, any attacks this round by your ship against the target get a to hit bonus equal to twice your Program skill. You can perform this multiple times in a round, targeting different ship each time.
Silent Running	Blue On Blue
This Action can only be attempted in a round where another ship has fired a weapon. Roll an Int/Program against difficulty 9. On a success, your ship cannot be targeted by enemy weapons and it gains a +2 bonus on all Pilot skill checks. The effect lasts until the beginning of your next turn or until your ship fires a weapon. You can perform this once per combat.	Roll an opposed Int/Program check against a target. On a success, chosen weapon of the target must roll to hit twice; if either roll misses, the shot misses, and the better of the two rolls is applied to hit a different enemy ship of the comms chief's choice. This only affects one attack per round. You can perform this multiple times in a round, targeting different weapon each time.
Phantom Course	
You briefly distorted the ship's apparent course, fooling enemies into making incorrect trajectory calculations. Roll an Int/Program check against difficulty 9. On a success, your ship receives a bonus equal to your Program skill level to all opposed Pilot and Program skill rolls made against your ship until the beginning of your next turn.	

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Engineering Actions

Engineering can perform damage control and boost the ship's systems.

Boost Engines	Hot Circuits
Roll an Int/Fix check against difficulty 8. On a success, the ship's Speed is increased by 2 until the start of the ship's next turn. You can perform this multiple times per round.	Roll an Int/Fix check against difficulty 9. On a success, all Comms Actions this round can be rolled again and the higher result taken.
Brace for Impact	Emergency Repairs
Roll an Int/Fix check against difficulty 9. On a success, next enemy attack that would deal damage deals half damage rounded up instead. This lasts until the start of your next turn.	Roll an Int/Fix check against difficulty 8. On a success, a disabled system is repaired or a damage-degraded drive has its rating increased by 1. Destroyed systems cannot be fixed this way.
Boost Damage	Damage Control
Roll an Int/Fix check against difficulty 9. On a success, one weapon on your ship may roll damage twice and take the highest result. This lasts until end of round. You may perform this multiple times per round, but the effect cannot be applied to same weapon more than once.	Roll an Int/Fix check against difficulty 7. On a success, repair a number of lost hit points equal to your Fix skill times 3 for frigates, 4 for cruisers, and 6 for capital-class hulls. Each attempt of this Action increases the difficulty of the next attempt in the same fight by +1.
Silence and Light	Far Past Red
Roll an Int/Fix or Int/Lead check against difficulty 9. On a success, the crew sacrifices their lives to keep the ship fighting. If the ship suffers any damage until the beginning of your next turn, 1d6 crewmembers are incapacitated as per Crew Lost Crisis; x2 for cruisers, and x8 for capital-class hulls. This can happen only once. The ship cannot be reduced below 1 hit points until the beginning of your next turn. Systems can still be disabled or destroyed, and any other effects of Crises are still counted. You cannot perform this again until the ship is fully repaired to full hit points.	Roll an Int/Fix check against difficulty 10. The engineer completely unlocks the governors on the fusion core. Until the beginning of your next turn, your ship gains +2 Speed, +2 AC, and it may roll weapon damage twice and take the higher result. You can perform this once per combat, and then an hour of repairs must be undertaken.

General Actions

Above and Beyond (Free)	Deal With a Crisis
Pick an attribute and a skill and explain how you're using them to help the ship. If the GM agrees, roll them against difficulty 9. On a success, you gain one Action Point that you may keep, or give to another department of your choice. On a failure, you lose one Action Point. You must not have taken Actions this turn to be able to use Above and Beyond. You can perform this once per round.	Explain what you are doing to solve a Crisis and roll the relevant skill check. The difficulty is usually 10, plus or minus 2 depending on the situation and how sound you plan is. On a success the Crisis is resolved. You may also use this action to aid another PC in resolving a Crisis, or to take one scene's worth of other actions around the ship. Deal With a Crisis is exclusive; if you take this Action you can do nothing else in the round.

Gunnery Actions

The gunnery department is in charge of the ship's weaponry.

Fire One Weapon	Fire All Guns
A gunner fires a single ship's weapon. A weapon can be fired a maximum of 5 times per round, no matter what Action was used.	Gunners fire all weapons mounted on the ship, designating targets as they wish. You can perform this once per round.
Suppressive Fire	Target a System
A gunner fires a single ship's weapon, chooses a target and rolls a Dex/Shoot or Int/Shoot check against a difficulty of 9. On a success, the target suffers a to hit penalty equal to your Shoot skill level, until the start of your next turn. This penalty applies even if the target shoots at some other vessel. You can perform this multiple times in a round, targeting different ship each time.	A gunner fires a single ship's weapon, targeting a weapon, engine, or fitting that the GM deems vulnerable. The attack takes -4 to hit. On a hit, do half damage (rounded up) before applying armor. If damage gets through, the system is disabled or the drive is degraded by 1 level. Disabled systems hit again are destroyed.
Counter-Fire	The Blood-Dimmed Tide
When an enemy attacks, you may fire a single weapon at +4 to hit as an Instant Action, regardless if the enemy attack hits or misses. Counter-Fire is resolved at the same time as the enemy attack. Counter-Fire lasts until you activate it or take any Action. You may only hold one Counter-Fire Action at a time. You may target a system using Counter-Fire, but if you do, you must choose the system when you use Counter-Fire and you get the usual penalty.	The gunners recklessly ignore all safety regulations and unleash volley after volley on the enemy. Roll a Wis/Shoot against difficulty 10. On a success, perform a Fire All Guns Action, but every gun may fire twice. Each gun rolls thrice to hit rolls, taking the best two to determine if the shots hit. This Action fries gunnery power capacitors. Neither this Action nor Fire All Guns can be performed again until the ship has had an hour to repair the damage.
Fire For Effect	
Roll an Int/Shoot or Dex/Shoot check against difficulty 9. On a success, target ship's Armor is reduced to half of its normal armor rounded up. The effect lasts until the end of your current turn.	

General Actions

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Pick an attribute and a skill and explain how you're using them to help the ship. If the GM agrees, roll them against difficulty 9. On a success, you gain one Action Point that you may keep, or give to another department of your choice. On a failure, you lose one Action Point. You must not have taken Actions this turn to be able to use Above and Beyond. You can perform this once per round.	Explain what you are doing to solve a Crisis and roll the relevant skill check. The difficulty is usually 10, plus or minus 2 depending on the situation and how sound you plan is. On a success the Crisis is resolved. You may also use this action to aid another PC in resolving a Crisis, or to take one scene's worth of other actions around the ship. Deal With a Crisis is exclusive; if you take this Action you can do nothing else in the round.

Fighter Actions

A fighter is a small, usually single-seat ship used for dogfighting.

Fire One Weapon	Target a System
Fire a single ship's weapon. A fighter weapon can be fired a maximum of 2 times per round, no matter what Action was used.	Fire a single ship's weapon, targeting a weapon, engine, or fitting that the GM deems vulnerable. The attack takes -4 to hit. On a hit, do half damage (rounded up) before applying armor. If damage gets through, the system is disabled or the drive is degraded by 1 level. Disabled systems hit again are destroyed.
Pursue Target	Escape Combat
Roll an opposed Int/Pilot or Dex/Pilot check plus Speed against the target. On a success you shed one point of Escape rating the target ship has on you.	Roll an opposed Int/Pilot or Dex/Pilot check plus Speed against the fastest opponent. On a success all enemy ships gain one point of Escape. If an enemy ship gets three points, your ship leaves combat. You may perform this twice per round.
Dogfight Maneuvering (Fighter Pilot)	Deal With a Crisis (Fighter Pilot)
Roll an opposed Int/Pilot or Dex/Pilot skill check plus Speed against a target ship. Whether you succeed or not, the target ship suffers a -2 penalty to hit you until the beginning of your next turn. On a success, you can also perform a Fire a Single Weapon Action without paying its AP cost.	Explain what you are doing to solve a Crisis and roll the relevant skill check. The difficulty is usually 12 due to the difficulty of resolving a crisis while having to pilot a fighter during combat. There can still be a plus or minus 2 depending on the situation and how sound you plan is. On a success the Crisis is resolved. If there are multiple crew on the fighter, you may also use this action to aid another crew member in resolving a Crisis. You can also use this to take one scene's worth of other actions on the fighter. Deal With a Crisis is exclusive; if you take this Action you can do nothing else in the round.
Evasive Maneuvers (Free)	
At the beginning of your turn before you have taken any Actions, you can choose to perform Evasive Maneuvers. You can add up to your Pilot skill to the ship's AC, but you also get a -X penalty to hit, where X is the number you chose. Evasive Maneuvers lasts until the beginning of your next turn.	